C6 · PHASE 1 · SET UP THE STORE WITH GENAI · TOPIC 3 · 10 MIN

Lab 3 — Let AI Build the New-Season Catalogue

Build a Professional eCommerce Store with Generative AI · LO3

> Rachel's WhatsApp notes become a WooCommerce CSV. Import it, add the polo's six variations, link the up-sells.

The business scenario

The Resort Linen pieces arrive next week. Rachel's product details are scattered WhatsApp messages. Typing four products by hand invites typos in SKUs and prices. ChatGPT turns her notes into an import-ready CSV; you import it with the core range, build the Premium Polo's size and colour variations, and link up-sells so customers see the next-best item.

You will deliver

- harbour-co-new-season.csv generated by AI from the supplier notes and checked by you
- Nine products imported by CSV into Apparel > Shirts, Apparel > Bottoms, Apparel > Outerwear and Accessories
- The Premium Polo Shirt as a variable product: 3 sizes × 2 colours = 6 priced, stocked variations
- Up-sell and cross-sell links on the Classic Cotton T-Shirt

Who does what

AI does — ChatGPT converts messy notes into a CSV with WooCommerce's exact column headers.

You decide — You check SKUs, prices and stock against the notes before importing — the importer will not.

OBJECTIVE

Ensure smooth maintenance and consistent bulk updates of the product catalogue.

Before you start

- Your demo WordPress site — log in at **/wp-admin** with **trainingN@tertiaryinfotech.com, where N is your site number (wp3 → training3@tertiaryinfotech.com)** and password **given by your trainer**.
- ChatGPT (https://chatgpt.com) — a free account works; image generation may be slower on the free tier.
- The Harbour & Co store from Labs 1–2 on your demo site.

Site	Login page	Username	Password
wp1	`https://wp1.tertiarytraining.com/wp-admin`	`training1@tertiaryinfotech.com`	`given by your trainer`
wp2	`https://wp2.tertiarytraining.com/wp-admin`	`training2@tertiaryinfotech.com`	`given by your trainer`
wp3	`https://wp3.tertiarytraining.com/wp-admin`	`training3@tertiaryinfotech.com`	`given by your trainer`

wp4	https://wp4.tertiarytraining.com/wp-admin	training4@tertiaryinfotech.com	given by your trainer
wp5	https://wp5.tertiarytraining.com/wp-admin	training5@tertiaryinfotech.com	given by your trainer

WordPress plugins and themes used

Plugin / theme	Where to get it
WooCommerce product CSV importer	Built in — Products > All Products > Import

In this folder

File	What it is
data/brand-brief.txt	Brand brief
data/supplier-notes.txt	Rachel's WhatsApp notes for the four new-season products
data/harbour-co-products.csv	Core range — five products, ready to import
data/harbour-co-new-season-reference.csv	Reference answer — import this if your AI CSV fails
data/polo-variations.csv	The six polo variations: size, colour, SKU, price
assets/images/	Starter images for every catalogue product
assets/descriptions/	Reference copy for every catalogue product

Step by step

1. Turn the supplier notes into a CSV

ChatGPT (chatgpt.com) — a new chat

Attach data/supplier-notes.txt and data/brand-brief.txt, then paste the prompt.

PROMPT — PASTE INTO CHATGPT

```
ROLE: You are an eCommerce catalogue manager who prepares WooCommerce imports.
CONTEXT: The attached supplier notes list four new Harbour & Co products. The brand brief sets the voice.
TASK: Produce a CSV for the WooCommerce product importer, one row per product.
CONSTRAINTS: Use exactly these headers in this order: Type,SKU,Name,Published,Short description,Regular price,Sale price,Categories,Tags,In stock?,Stock,Weight (kg)
Type = simple. Published = 1. In stock? = 1. Categories use ' > ' for hierarchy, e.g. Apparel > Bottoms. Weight in kg (250g = 0.25). Prices are numbers with no S$ sign. Leave Sale price empty when there is no promo. Short description ≤ 25 words in the brand voice, built only from the notes. Wrap any field containing a comma in double quotes. Tag every linen or resort item with 'resort'.
FORMAT: One CSV code block only, then a table listing each SKU with its price and stock so I can check them.
```

✓ Four rows. Save the code block as harbour-co-new-season.csv (UTF-8).

2. Check the CSV against the notes

You (a spreadsheet or text editor)

Compare each SKU, price, sale price, stock and category with the notes. Fix mistakes in the file, not in ChatGPT.

```
RESORT-SHIRT-001 59.90 · 30
TROUSER-LINEN-001 69.90 · 30 · Apparel > Bottoms
SKIRT-MIDI-001 54.90 / sale 46.90 · 25
BAG-RATTAN-001 45.90 · 20 · Accessories
```

3. Import the core range

Products > All Products > Import

Choose data/harbour-co-products.csv, click Continue, review the column mapping, then Run the importer.

✓ 'Import complete! 5 products imported.'

4. Import your AI-generated CSV

Products > All Products > Import

Repeat with harbour-co-new-season.csv. If the importer rejects it, import data/harbour-co-new-season-reference.csv instead and compare the two files to see why.

✓ 4 products imported; Apparel > Bottoms is created automatically.

5. Create the variable polo

Products > Add new product

Title Premium Polo Shirt. In Product data change Simple product to Variable product.

```
Title: Premium Polo Shirt   ·   Product data: Variable product   ·   Category: Apparel > Shirts
```

6. Add Size and Colour attributes

Product data > Attributes

Add a custom attribute Size, then Colour. Tick 'Used for variations' on both and Save attributes.

```
Size:  S | M | L
Colour:  Black | White
```

7. Generate and price the six variations

Product data > Variations

Click Generate variations. Expand each one and enter its SKU, price and stock (see data/polo-variations.csv). Set the default form values to M / Black. Publish.

```
POLO-S-BLK 39.90 · POLO-M-BLK 39.90 · POLO-L-BLK 41.90
POLO-S-WHT 39.90 · POLO-M-WHT 39.90 · POLO-L-WHT 41.90   ·   Stock 25 each
```

✓ The product page shows S$39.90 – S$41.90 and Size / Colour dropdowns.

8. Link up-sells and cross-sells

Classic Cotton T-Shirt > Product data > Linked Products

Up-sell the more premium polo on the product page; cross-sell the cap and tote in the cart. Update.

```
Upsells: Premium Polo Shirt   ·   Cross-sells: Cotton Cap, Canvas Tote Bag
```

9. Ask AI for a catalogue audit

Same ChatGPT chat

Export the catalogue (Products > All Products > Export > Generate CSV), attach the file and paste the prompt.

PROMPT — PASTE INTO CHATGPT

```
ROLE: You are a catalogue QA analyst.
CONTEXT: The attached file is Harbour & Co's full product export.
TASK: Find maintenance problems: missing images, missing short descriptions, duplicate or
malformed SKUs, products with no category or still in 'Uncategorized', sale prices higher than
regular prices, stock of 0.
FORMAT: A table: SKU · problem · fix. Then the three fixes that matter most for customers.
```

✓ A short fix list — most rows will say 'no image' until you add the starter images.

Prompt Playbook — Step → Prompt → Step → Prompt

The whole lab on one page. YOU steps happen in WordPress; AI steps are prompts you paste into ChatGPT (copy them from `COPY-PROMPTS.txt` or the Lab Prompts page). Attach `data/brand-brief.txt` before the first prompt.

AI · STEP 1 **Turn the supplier notes into a CSV**

```
ROLE: You are an eCommerce catalogue manager who prepares WooCommerce imports.
CONTEXT: The attached supplier notes list four new Harbour & Co products. The brand brief sets the voice.
TASK: Produce a CSV for the WooCommerce product importer, one row per product.
CONSTRAINTS: Use exactly these headers in this order: Type,SKU,Name,Published,Short description,Regular price,Sale price,Categories,Tags,In stock?,Stock,Weight (kg)
Type = simple. Published = 1. In stock? = 1. Categories use ' > ' for hierarchy, e.g. Apparel > Bottoms. Weight in kg (250g = 0.25). Prices are numbers with no S$ sign. Leave Sale price empty when there is no promo. Short description ≤ 25 words in the brand voice, built only from the notes. Wrap any field containing a comma in double quotes. Tag every linen or resort item with 'resort'.
FORMAT: One CSV code block only, then a table listing each SKU with its price and stock so I can check them.
```

✓ Four rows. Save the code block as harbour-co-new-season.csv (UTF-8).

YOU · STEP 2 **Check the CSV against the notes** — You (a spreadsheet or text editor)

YOU · STEP 3 **Import the core range** — Products > All Products > Import

YOU · STEP 4 **Import your AI-generated CSV** — Products > All Products > Import

YOU · STEP 5 **Create the variable polo** — Products > Add new product

YOU · STEP 6 **Add Size and Colour attributes** — Product data > Attributes

YOU · STEP 7 **Generate and price the six variations** — Product data > Variations

YOU · STEP 8 **Link up-sells and cross-sells** — Classic Cotton T-Shirt > Product data > Linked Products

AI · STEP 9 **Ask AI for a catalogue audit**

```
ROLE: You are a catalogue QA analyst.
CONTEXT: The attached file is Harbour & Co's full product export.
TASK: Find maintenance problems: missing images, missing short descriptions, duplicate or malformed SKUs, products with no category or still in 'Uncategorized', sale prices higher than regular prices, stock of 0.
FORMAT: A table: SKU · problem · fix. Then the three fixes that matter most for customers.
```

✓ A short fix list — most rows will say 'no image' until you add the starter images.

Checkpoint

All Products lists 11 products, the polo shows S$39.90 – S$41.90, and Apparel has Shirts, Bottoms and Outerwear under it.

- □ Nine CSV-imported products plus the T-shirt and polo appear in All Products
- □ Categories: Apparel > Shirts, Apparel > Bottoms, Apparel > Outerwear and Accessories
- □ The polo has six variations, each with SKU, price and stock
- □ The T-shirt up-sells the polo and cross-sells the cap and tote

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
Importer: 'Invalid file type'	Save as .csv (UTF-8). In Excel use 'CSV UTF-8 (Comma delimited)'.
Columns land in the wrong fields	On the mapping screen choose the right WooCommerce field for each column, or fix the header spelling.
'Import complete' but 0 products imported	You ticked 'Update existing products'. That option only updates SKUs already in the store and skips new ones — untick it for a first import.
A variation is missing from the dropdown	Every variation needs its own price. Expand it and enter the Regular price.
Cotton Cap is not in the cross-sell search	Create it first (Lab 2 challenge) or pick another accessory.

Stretch challenge

Add the starter images to the nine imported products and ask ChatGPT to write a 2-line category description for Apparel > Bottoms.

Keep your demo site as it is at the end of the lab — the next lab builds on this work.

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